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FROM: AMLEGATION, Bern
TO: Secretary of State, Washington
DATED: June 22, 1943.
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CONFIDENTIAL

SECTION ONE

This is in reference to telegram no. 3567, dated June 14, from Bern.

Burckardt and Schwarzenberg of International Red Cross Committee have furnished the following information to James, representative of the American Red Cross:

A. There are approximately 80,000 Jews, estimated at 30,000 men, 36,000 women and 14,000 children, living in widely scattered farms and villages throughout Transnistria. Clothing is needed by 90% of the children and 75% of the adults. Primary needs of these Jews, as stated by Intercross, are clothing, supplies, and food, in this order, especially milk, and fortifying, vitamin-rich food. It probably will be difficult to purchase clothing, but foodstuffs can be purchased in Rumania, Intercross believes, although it does not have exact information at hand.

B. Jewish organizations in Rumania have raised a considerable amount of money to be used for relief in Transnistria, but have informed Intercross that they are in need of funds.

SECTION TWO

C. The practical solution, as expressed by Burckardt, is that repayment of funds for financial relief in Rumania through the utilization of funds in Rumania be made in blocked dollars in the United States, but that in the exchange transactions that committee could not be involved. Speaking for the Committee, he stated that it agreed in principle to assume control and would work cooperatively with the local organizations, should relief be made available for Jews in Transnistria.

D. Bulgarian Government has closed its frontier to Jews, although Rumanian Government has taken a helpful attitude toward amicable settlement of Jews, Intercross confirms. The willingness to try to obtain vessels and to apply for German safe-conduct for evacuation by sea is expressed by Rumanians. Should the sea route be possible, Russian safe-conduct will be necessary, but since Intercross has no delegation in Russia, it is not in a favorable position to obtain permission of Russians.

HARRISON